2. Marks and Standards

The following marks and standards apply to the majority of University of Limerick programmes. Programme-specific regulations that fall outside the realm of these marks and standards are given in chapter 4 of this handbook.

2.1 Assessment

2.1.1 The University defines **assessment** as a generic term for a set of processes that measure the outcome of students' learning in terms of knowledge acquired, understanding developed and skills or abilities gained. Assessment may be categorised as either coursework (see 2.1.2) or examination (see 2.1.3) and may be diagnostic, formative or summative in nature.

2.1.2 The University defines **coursework** as a form of assessment that relies upon performance in (but not limited to) one or more of the following: practical work, essays, exercises, seminar papers, reports, presentations, class tests, projects or the production of artefacts, design, theses, dissertations and similar work, and such other means of assessing performance as may have been approved or prescribed by the Academic Council in relation to any programme of study.

2.1.3 The University defines **examination** as a form of in-person assessment that relies upon students producing written or oral answers to seen or unseen questions under centrally arranged and managed formal examination conditions.

2.1.4 The Provost & Deputy President shall have overall responsibility for the conduct of assessments at the University and shall, in particular, ensure that:

a) Appropriate assessment processes are in place for each student
b) Any reasonable accommodations including, but not limited to, alternatives to printed material and/or examination booklets, additional time, special facilities and/or arrangements, special assistance such as readers, and/or other approved special forms of assessment are in place for each student
c) Examinations and/or coursework are prepared by internal examiners and approved by external examiners
d) Maximum security is implemented in all matters pertaining to assessment to ensure a high level of academic integrity
e) Examinations and/or coursework are assessed by internal examiners and results for each candidate, as approved by the external examiners, are made available for meetings of Academic Council Examination Boards
f) Accurate records relating to coursework, along with all associated materials, are maintained and made available as required, particularly to external examiners
g) Proper arrangements are made for holding meetings of the Academic Council and Faculty Examination Boards in accordance with the provisions of section 2.3 below
h) The recommendations of meetings of Academic Council Examination Boards are transmitted in a timely manner to the Academic Council

2.2 Examiners

2.2.1 Academic staff members who are responsible for assessment functions shall be deemed to be internal examiners.

2.2.2 In the case of a module in which the teaching is shared by more than one academic staff member, the appropriate Head of Department shall nominate an academic staff member as internal examiner for that module.

2.2.3 The role of the internal examiner shall be as follows:

a) To prepare, in consultation either directly or through course directors and/or Heads of Department, appropriate assessment instruments that accord with internationally established and accepted academic practice and reflect internationally acceptable academic standards
b) To take due account of comments and amendments proposed by the external examiner(s)
c) To submit the agreed examination materials in good time and in sufficient quantities to Academic Registry (SP 3.1.2)
d) To propose module grades to be awarded to each candidate
e) To attend and contribute to the deliberations of meetings of the appropriate Academic Council Examination Boards

2.2.4 On the recommendation of the Academic Council, external examiners are appointed by the Governing Authority so that internal examiners can properly and effectively discharge their duties set out in 2.2.3 and to support the quality assurance processes of the University as required under the Quality & Qualifications (Education & Training) Act, 2012 as amended.

2.2.5 External examiners are appointed by Academic Council to act independently and impartially within the following remits: Examiner of the Outcome & Standards, Auditor of the Process, and Consultant to the Curriculum.

2.2.6 The External Examiner Policy governs matters relating to external examiners, including a more detailed remit, roles and responsibilities, duties, visits, reporting, interactions, appointments, fees and expenses, administrative supports and general operational aspects.

2.2.7 In the event of an unresolved matter between the external and internal examiners, the Academic Council shall adjudicate on the matter in question, and its decision shall be final.

2.3 Examination Boards

2.3.1 An Examination Board shall be convened by each faculty. The Faculty Examination Board shall make recommendations to the Academic Council Examination Board.

2.3.2 Academic Council Examination Boards shall make recommendations to the Academic Council in relation to the awards to be made to students who have completed the University's programmes of study.

2.3.3 The dates of Academic Council Examination Board meetings shall be determined by the Provost & Deputy President, who shall convene such meetings at appropriate times.

2.3.4 The Academic Council Examination Board shall comprise the Provost & Deputy President or their nominee (chairperson), all internal examiners who participated in the assessments for the award(s) for which candidates are to be considered at the Examination Board meeting and all external examiners relevant to the subjects and awards to be considered at the Examination Board meeting.

2.3.5 The external examiners are entitled to contribute fully to the deliberations and decisions of the Examination Board meetings.

2.3.6 On approval by Faculty Examination Boards, candidates' proposed awards are presented at the Academic Council Examination Board meeting.

2.3.7 Meetings of Academic Council Examination Boards should allow for full and frank discussion of any individual cases before a final recommendation is made to the Academic Council.

2.3.8 Decisions of the Academic Council Examination Board shall be submitted as recommendations to the Academic Council, which shall consider and have the right to adopt, modify or reject

such recommendations.

2.3.9 At the meeting of the Academic Council Examination Board, the cumulative performance results record of each candidate shall be presented and endorsed and, in relation to each candidate's overall result, a decision will be recorded, indicating:

a) The level of award to be conferred, or
b) The student has been deferred, or
c) The student is being recommended for a postgraduate award by research and thesis

2.3.10 Every effort shall be made by the internal and external examiners to agree final module grades prior to the Examination Board meeting. In the event of a grading disagreement that remains unresolved between examiners prior to the Examination Board meeting, an examiner who continues to dissent at the meeting shall have the right to have their dissenting opinion appended to the Examination Board record.

2.3.11 The Examination Board record shall be signed by the chairperson and secretary of the meeting and by examiners (external and internal) present at the meeting. The Examination Board record shall be forwarded by the Provost & Deputy President to the Academic Council at the earliest opportunity following the Examination Board meeting.

2.3.12 Any dissenting opinion by an examiner that shall have been appended to the Examination Board record shall be brought to the attention of the Academic Council, whose decision in relation thereto shall be final, as provided for in 2.3.8 above.

2.3.13 The proceedings and deliberations of Academic Council Examination Boards are strictly confidential. Under no circumstances should any person attending a meeting of a board disclose to any other person a decision of the board or any document, information or opinion considered, conveyed or expressed at the meeting.

2.3.14 Notwithstanding 2.3.13, in the event that an Academic Council meeting is not pending and where unanimous agreement has been expressed by internal and external examiners, the Academic Council Examination Board may decide to allow publication of the decisions and awards being recommended to Academic Council. The awards recommended by the Academic Council Examination Board are provisional awards, and Academic Council retains the right to amend all such awards.

2.4 Academic Awards

2.4.1 The granting of a University award shall be on the basis of a candidate's performance in assessments or other tests of the attainment of learning outcomes that have been duly set by the academic staff members of the University and approved and monitored by external examiner(s).

2.4.2 The Academic Council shall meet to consider the recommendations of a duly constituted meeting of an Academic Council Examination Board. The decisions of the Academic Council in the case of each candidate considered shall be final, and appropriate awards shall be granted to the candidate by the University. This meeting of the Academic Council shall occur as soon after the Examination Board meeting as is practicable.

2.4.3 The Provost & Deputy President shall communicate the relevant decisions of the Academic Council to each candidate at the earliest possible opportunity. Where the candidate is to receive an award of the University, the Provost & Deputy President shall invite the candidate to the next relevant conferring ceremony of the University, where the candidate will be conferred with the award attained.

2.4.4 Where it can be demonstrated that an award was granted in error, the Academic Council, having considered the circumstances, may take such action as deemed appropriate, which

includes but is not limited to reclassification or withdrawal of the award.

2.4.5 Undergraduate and postgraduate students are not permitted to defer their conferring. Students not attending will be conferred in absentia.

2.4.6 PhD and Professional Doctorate candidates are permitted to defer their conferring by one conferring session.

2.5 Grading

2.5.1 A grade that is representative of the quality of a student's performance in a particular module shall be awarded at the end of each semester for each module the student has taken.

2.5.2 The table to follow lists the module grades that can be awarded.

Table 2.1: Academic Module Grades

Grade	Grade Descriptors: Meta Level (Indicative grade descriptors at module level will be determined in accordance with regulation AR 1.4.3)	QPV	Credits Awarded
A1	Outstanding Performance *(First honours)*	4.00	Yes
A2	Excellent Performance *(First honours)*	3.60	Yes
B1	Very Good Performance *(Honours 2.1)*	3.20	Yes
B2	Good Performance *(Honours 2.1)*	3.00	Yes
B3	Competent Performance *(Honours 2.2)*	2.80	Yes
C1	Satisfactory Performance *(Honours 2.2)*	2.60	Yes
C2	Acceptable Performance *(Third honours)*	2.40	Yes
C3	Minimally Acceptable Performance *(Third honours)*	2.00	Yes
D1	Weak Performance *(compensating fail)*	1.60	Yes
F	Fail *(no compensation allowed)*	0.00	No
NG	Fail *(no compensation allowed)*	0.00	No
P	Pass in a module taken on a pass/fail basis	–	Yes
N	Failure in a module taken on a pass/fail basis	–	No

2.5.3 The minimum mark to achieve a C3 grade is set at 40%, with D1 set at 35<40%.

2.5.4 The grades F, NG, I, I2, M and N are considered deficient grades as credits have not been awarded, and credits must be achieved to allow progression or graduation.

2.5.5 The following administrative grades can also apply and, if applicable, shall appear on students' transcripts.

Table 2.2: Administrative Grades

Grade	Meaning	QPV	Credits Awarded
EX	Student exempted from the requirements of the module because of previous equivalent study or work. Full credits awarded.	–	Yes
R	Student repeating this module. Grade for repeat inserted in previous attempt at module. Uncapped repeat.	–	No
G	Audit	_	No
I	Incomplete (I) Grade	_	No
I2	2nd Incomplete (I) grade following Annual Repeats	_	No
M	Awarded in cases of projects spanning multiple semesters or sequences of linked modules	_	No
RE	Student's enrolment terminated. New enrolment contains uncapped repeats undertaken for these modules.	–	No
X	An X grade will appear on the student's transcript when the student is due to clear an I grade in a module.	–	No
Y	A Y grade will appear on the student's transcript when the student is due to clear a grade in a deficient module.	–	No
W	Student formally withdrew from the University. A termination of student enrolment form must be completed.	–	No

2.6 Bachelor's Degrees, Diplomas and Certificates

2.6.1 The award of a bachelor's degree, diploma (either undergraduate or postgraduate) or certificate (either undergraduate or postgraduate) is made at honours levels. To qualify for the award of a bachelor's degree or diploma or certificate, a candidate must:

a) Satisfy all the assessment and other requirements set for the programme of study
b) Achieve a minimum final cumulative QCA of 2.00, with full credits in all prescribed modules of the programme of study
c) Satisfy any programme-specific regulations as specified for particular programmes

2.6.2 Awards will be at one of the following classifications:

Award Classification	Cumulative QCA
First class honours	3.30
Second class honours grade 1 (2.1)	2.90
Second class honours grade 2 (2.2)	2.50
Third class honours	2.00

2.6.3 In the case of programmes that consist of a part 1 and part 2 structure, the award and award classification shall be made on the basis of performance of candidates in part 2 only of such programmes. Where there are more than two years in part 2 of the programme, a relative weighting of 1:2:2 shall be assigned to years 1, 2 and 3 of part 2, respectively. In the case of all other programmes, the award of the degree shall be based on the candidate's full cumulative performance over the complete programme.

2.6.4 In the case of a student pursuing joint or dual awards, it is expected that at least 30% and not more than 70% of the taught credits in the programme of study will be offered by UL.

2.7 Taught Master's Degree

2.7.1 A master's degree by coursework and dissertation (or equivalent) may be awarded at honours classification (first class, second class or third class honours). To be eligible for the award of a master's degree by coursework and dissertation (or equivalent) at honours classification, a candidate must:

a) satisfy all the assessment and other requirements set for the programme of study
b) have achieved a minimum grade of C3 in the dissertation component of the programme
c) achieve a minimum final cumulative QCA of 2.00, with full credits in all prescribed elements of the programme of study

2.7.2 In the case of taught master's degree programmes with an optional graduate diploma exit award, a student availing of the graduate diploma exit award may not register to complete the outstanding requirements for the related master's award within the 12-month period following the end of the final semester containing modules required to qualify for the graduate diploma.

2.7.3 In the case of a linked graduate diploma/master's degree programme of which the taught element, in whole or in part, constitutes a graduate diploma programme, a student shall be required to attain a minimum honours 2.2 standard in the taught component to be eligible for progression to the master's component of the programme.

2.7.4 All cases referred to and provided for in 2.7.2 shall require the approval of the appropriate faculty postgraduate studies committee for progression to the master's component of the programme in question.

2.7.5 The classification of honours awards shall be determined as follows:

Award Classification	Cumulative QCA
First class honours	3.30
Second class honours grade 1 (2.1)	2.90
Second class honours grade 2 (2.2)	2.50
Third class honours	2.00

2.8 Master's Degree (by Research and Thesis)

2.8.1 A master's degree by research and thesis is of honours standard and is awarded without classification. Subject to its successful completion, the thesis has a nominal value of 180 European Credit Transfer and Accumulation System (ECTS) credits.

2.9 Professional Doctorate

2.9.1 The professional doctorate is awarded to a candidate on the basis of the candidate having followed a prescribed programme of study and research. The programme may also include an experiential and/or professional placement element.

2.9.2 The degree of professional doctorate is awarded without classification. Subject to its successful completion, the professional doctorate has a nominal value of 270 ECTS credits.

2.9.3 Students must satisfactorily complete all elements of the taught programme and have achieved a cumulative QCA of 3.00 or higher to be considered for the award of the professional doctorate.

2.10 Doctor of Philosophy – Traditional Model

2.10.1 The degree of Doctor of Philosophy (PhD) is the highest academic qualification awarded by the University and is awarded to successful candidates on the strength of a body of original work of scholarship prepared and presented in accordance with internationally accepted academic standards and in the form of a doctoral thesis.

2.10.2 The degree of PhD is awarded without classification. Subject to its successful completion, the thesis has a nominal value of 270 ECTS credits.

2.11 Doctor of Philosophy – Structured PhD

2.11.1 A Structured PhD degree is awarded on the strength of the successful completion of a structured programme of research, study, and personal and professional development.

2.11.2 Candidates who wish to pursue a Structured PhD programme will:

a) Have a primary supervisor (or supervisors) and a Supervisory Panel, which will be involved in the annual progression assessment
b) Undertake a training needs analysis and maintain a Personal Development Plan (PDP)
c) Undertake discipline-specific modules, research skills, and generic and transferable skills courses as agreed in their PDP, to the value of at least 30 ECTS credits

2.11.3 The total credits from a combination of the taught and research elements of a Structured PhD will not be fewer than 300 and not more than 360 ECTS credits. Within these overall limits, the credits for the Structured PhD are made up as follows:

a) A research thesis equivalent to 270 ECTS credits
b) Technical/discipline-specific courses of a minimum of 20 and up to a maximum of 80 ECTS credits
c) Research, transferable and generic skills courses of a minimum of 10 and up to a maximum of 50 ECTS credits (pass/fail)

See Appendix 4 of chapter 5 for further details on the Structured PhD.

2.12 Aegrotat Awards

2.12.1 An aegrotat award may be awarded to a student who has died or is unable to complete their programme of study due to very serious illness or other grave circumstances. An award made on an aegrotat basis is unclassified and does not entitle the student to the benefits of an award of the university, including meeting the entry requirements of a programme of further study, exemptions or recognition by professional bodies or the right to practise in a profession. In the event that a student who has received an aegrotat award makes a significant recovery from an illness, the student may be permitted to re-enter the programme of study.

2.12.2 Students eligible for consideration are those who:

a) Are on a taught programme of study of minimum 60 ECTS credits and have completed at least two-thirds of the programme of study; or
b) Are on a research master's programme of study (180 ECTS credits) for at least one full calendar year and have successfully progressed following all annual review; or
c) Are on a professional doctorate or PhD programme of study or other research programme of study of minimum 270 ECTS credits for a least two full calendar years and have successfully progressed following all annual reviews

2.12.3 The award title will reflect the title of the degree programme (reference to Professional Qualification, where applicable, will be removed).

2.12.4 The award level will not be classified (in terms of first-class honours, etc.).

2.12.5 The award is not aligned with the National Framework of Qualifications.

2.12.6 The recommendation by a Faculty Examination Board to award an aegrotat award will be considered at the next scheduled meeting of the University Examination Board and then at the next scheduled meeting of the Academic Council. In exceptional circumstances, the Dean of Faculty may request the Provost & Deputy President to convene an exceptional University Examination Board meeting to consider a Faculty Examination Board aegrotat award recommendation. The exceptional University Examination Board has delegated power from

Academic Council to approve an aegrotat award. Aegrotat awards will be conferred at the next conferring ceremony or, in exceptional circumstances, at another appropriate ceremony.

2.13 Posthumous Awards

2.13.1 A posthumous award may be awarded to a student who has died without having met the eligibility criteria for an aegrotat award. To be eligible for a posthumous award, the deceased student must have completed at least 30 ECTS credits on a taught programme or successfully passed at least one annual progression review on a research programme.

2.13.2 The award title will reflect the title of the degree programme (reference to Professional Qualification, where applicable, will be removed).

2.13.3 The award level will not be classified (in terms of first-class honours, etc.).

2.13.4 The award is not aligned with the National Framework of Qualifications.

2.13.5 A Faculty Examination Board's recommendation to confer a posthumous award will be considered at the next scheduled meeting of the University Examination Board and then at the next scheduled meeting of the Academic Council. The parchment may be presented to the next of kin at a future conferring ceremony.

2.14 Deferral of Examination Results

2.14.1 A board of examiners may recommend that a final decision on a candidate's result be deferred to enable the candidate to complete specific outstanding requirements of the programme of study that the candidate has pursued.

2.14.2 Any deferral of a decision in relation to a candidate's result shall be for a limited period, normally not exceeding one academic year.

2.15 Applicability of Marks and Standards

2.15.1 These general marks and standards and all associated procedures shall apply to all assessments and examinations leading to University of Limerick awards unless and until amended by the Academic Council. These marks and standards shall be read and interpreted in conjunction with the academic regulations determined from time to time by the Academic Council and shall apply to all programmes of study that stand approved by the Academic Council and that lead to University of Limerick awards. Course approval documentation adopted by the Academic Council shall stipulate compliance with the provisions of these marks and standards.

3. Supporting Procedures

3.1 Assessment

3.1.1 Examination Scheduling

3.1.1.1 Academic Registry shall schedule and administer an examination period of not more than 2.5 hours for each module requiring an examination. (Special exemption for an examination of longer duration may be requested from the Academic Council by application to the Office of the Provost & Deputy President.)

3.1.1.2 Where a student identifies a provisional examination timetable clash (two examinations at the same time) related to their modules, they should notify Academic Registry immediately via TopDesk. Where a clash is due to registration issues, Academic Registry may adjust the provisional examination timetable or put other arrangements in place to address the clash.

3.1.1.3 End-of-semester examinations shall be conducted in accordance with the regulations specified in section 3.5.

3.1.2 Preparing Examination Material

3.1.2.1 Academic staff members shall comply with any procedures and deadlines their academic department has in place regarding the preparation of examination materials whether in paper or electronic format (AR 1.4.4 and MS 2.1). In the case of examinations, these procedures and deadlines shall be designed to comply with the requirements at 3.1.2.2 and 3.1.2.3 below.

3.1.2.2 Sufficient copies of the examination material whether in paper or electronic format, shall be delivered to Academic Registry five working days before the first examination.

3.1.2.3 All examination papers, in paper or electronic format, shall contain standard header information.

3.1.3 Academic Staff Attendance at Examinations

3.1.3.1 The academic staff member responsible for a module or their nominee shall be present at the scheduled examination venue of the examination for the first 30 minutes of the scheduled examination time to respond to queries. Where the final schedule lists more than one examination venue for the module examination, the academic staff member or their nominee shall attend at the main venues listed on the final examination schedule. The academic staff member or their nominee is required to present UL staff identification to the Exam Venue Coordinator prior to entering the examination venue.

3.1.3.2 If an examination question paper (whether in paper or electronic format) containing inaccurate information is distributed to students in an examination venue, the academic staff member shall immediately bring this to the attention of the Exam Venue Coordinator.

3.1.4 Academic Misconduct

3.1.4.1 Academic misconduct is defined in the Academic Integrity Policy. Academic misconduct is categorised according to three levels, which are defined in chapter 6, Student Code of Conduct (2.2) and in the Procedures for Managing Allegations of Academic Misconduct.

3.1.4.2 Anyone who believes that they see a student attempting to cheat or cheating during an examination shall immediately inform an Exam Venue Coordinator in the examination venue of the time and nature of the allegation and shall indicate to the Exam Venue Coordinator where the student concerned is seated. The Exam Venue Coordinator will then follow the Breach of General Examination Regulations procedure used to record such an allegation. The procedure permits the student concerned to continue with the examination. Academic

Registry shall refer all such allegations to the Office of the Provost & Deputy President immediately following the examination concerned. All allegations and complaints are considered by the Academic Integrity Unit under the Student Code of Conduct.

3.1.4.3 Anyone who believes that a student is attempting to engage in academic misconduct or engages in academic misconduct during an assessment by coursework shall immediately inform the academic staff member responsible for the module. The academic staff member shall inform the student concerned of the allegation. (If it is the academic staff member who believes an incident of cheating has occurred, they shall similarly inform the student concerned.) The academic staff member should then act in accordance with the Procedures for Managing Allegations of Academic Misconduct.

3.1.4.4 Allegations and complaints of academic misconduct are considered to be breaches of the Student Code of Conduct and should be managed in accordance with the Procedures for Managing Allegations of Academic Misconduct. An academic staff member who believes that a student has engaged in academic misconduct based on an analysis of the student's assessment answer materials (coursework or examination) should act in accordance with the Procedures for Managing Allegations of Academic Misconduct. All allegations and complaints are considered by the Academic Integrity Unit under the Student Code of Conduct.

3.2 Grading

3.2.1 Grading Lists

3.2.1.1 A grading list that lists each student taking a module in the current semester shall be sent by Academic Registry to the academic staff member responsible for the module by the end of Week 13 of the semester. (AR 1.4.7)

3.2.1.2 The academic staff member responsible for the module shall ensure that:

a) The final grade each student has achieved in the module is submitted on the grading list
b) The name, ID number and grade of any student who is not included on the list but who has been assessed in the module in the current semester is submitted using the Module Grade Entry Additional Students document

3.2.2 Submission of Grades

3.2.2.1 The academic staff member responsible for the module shall review the completed grading list and shall submit final grades to the SI records system. After the grades for a module have been submitted, an email confirmation detailing the grade distribution and average QPV for the module will be sent to the Module Leader, Head of Department and Department Coordinator.

3.2.2.2 The Head of Department or their nominee shall review the grades submitted by the academic staff member and may, within a period of three days from the date of notice of grade submission, request Academic Registry to return the grading list to the academic staff member.

3.2.2.3 Academic staff members are encouraged to submit grades at the earliest opportunity following the completion of assessments in a module. Heads of department shall make every effort to support academic staff in so doing.

3.2.2.4 The precise dates and deadlines in each semester will be confirmed by memo to all members of academic staff from Academic Registry.

3.2.2.5 The grades that may be awarded are listed in the Marks and Standards chapter (MS 2.5.2). Academic staff members should refer to their Head of Department for more detailed guidance on the standard of performance required for the award of each grade. The student participation type listed on the class and grading lists issued by Academic Registry has the following implications for the type of grade for which the student is eligible.

Table 4.1: Student Participation Type

Participation Type	Meaning	Associated Grades
N	Normal participation	Award any grade except G, EX, R, RE, W, X, S, Y
P	Pass/Fail participation	Award grade P (Pass) or N (Fail) only
G	Audit participation	Award G or NG only
No cap	Repeat participation	Award appropriate academic grade
Cap	Repeat participation type where the grade is capped	Award appropriate academic grade. The system will cap to a maximum of C3 while maintaining an audit record of the actual grade awarded.
I clear	Participation to clear I grade	Award appropriate academic grade

3.2.3 **Incomplete (I) Grades**

3.2.3.1 The University supports students who find themselves in an immediate crisis that has a substantial and material effect on their ability to prepare for or participate in an examination/assessment and, where relevant, takes actions to avert recurrence.

3.2.3.2 An incomplete (I) grade shall be granted only in cases where the student has not attended the relevant examination (if required) and/or submitted all coursework for assessment (if required).

3.2.3.3 Incomplete (I) grades are granted for individual modules.

3.2.3.4 Module credit is not awarded for incomplete (I) grades.

3.2.3.5 An incomplete (I) grade in a module that is a required part of a student's programme must be replaced by an appropriate academic grade prior to progression or graduation.

3.2.3.6 An incomplete (I) grade shall be awarded only in cases where there is certifiable evidence of one (or more) of the following:

a) Illness/condition, if within sufficient proximity to the examination/assessment to have a substantial and material effect
b) Death of a person close to the applicant including (but not limited to) a parent/guardian, sibling, spouse, child (or person to whom the applicant is in *loco parentis*), mother-in-law, father-in-law, grandparent, grandchild or any person who was habitually resident in the home of the applicant, if within sufficient proximity to the examination/assessment to have a substantial and material effect
c) Circumstances outside the control of the applicant, which make it legally, factually or physically impossible for the applicant to attend an examination/assessment or if within sufficient proximity to an examination/assessment to have a substantial and material effect
d) Pregnancy and related issues
e) Other circumstances that the Incomplete (I) Grade Committee considers to be analogous to any of the aforementioned

3.2.3.7 For the avoidance of doubt, incomplete (I) grades shall not be assigned in response to pleas of pressure of work.

3.2.3.8 An incomplete (I) grade shall be granted only in cases where the student has submitted certifiable evidence that meets the requirements set by the Incomplete (I) Grade Committee at the times and in the manner specified from time to time by the University.

3.2.3.9 To be considered for an incomplete (I) grade, it is the responsibility of the student to complete all application requirements at the times and in the manner specified to the student from time to time by the University.

3.2.3.10 The Incomplete (I) Grade Committee will meet to consider all applications for incomplete grades following each examination period and will make a recommendation for the granting of incomplete (I) grades to the Academic Council Grading Committee (see AR 1.1.2).

3.2.3.11 Students are informed of the outcome of their application for an incomplete (I) grade when results are released for the relevant semester (see AR 1.4.13).

3.2.3.12 Students who wish to appeal the decision of the Academic Council Grading Committee in relation to the awarding, or not, of an incomplete (I) grade may do so at the times and in the manner specified to the student from time to time by the University.

3.2.3.13 Students shall be required to clear all incomplete (I) grades no later than the repeat assessment period following the award of the incomplete (I) grade or in the case of non-repeatable modules, the next time the module is offered.

3.2.3.14 Students who receive an incomplete (I) grade for the first time in a module during the repeat assessment period will retain their original grade.

3.2.3.15 Students who receive an incomplete (I) grade during the repeat assessment period may not progress on their programme of study until they are awarded full credits in all modules of the prescribed programme to date (see AR 1.5.3).

3.2.3.16 All clearance grades will be processed following the relevant Repeat Assessment period with the exception of prospective graduating students where clearance of I grades awarded in a student's penultimate semester may be considered by the Academic Council Grading Committee either prior to the next relevant Academic Council Examination Board or following the relevant Repeat Assessment period.

3.2.3.17 A student who receives an incomplete (I) grade shall contact the academic staff member responsible for the module immediately following the publication of the grade to determine how the outstanding requirements are to be completed. If the academic staff member is unavailable, the student should contact the appropriate Head of Department for a decision.

3.2.3.18 The academic staff member responsible for the module shall determine which of the following options apply for a student to meet the outstanding requirements and clear the incomplete (I) grade:

a) An evaluation of the work submitted by the student to date together with the student's general performance in the module to date
b) An adequately documented *viva voce* examination
c) Performance in sequential or linked modules
d) Evidence of mastery of concepts or skills that can be obtained from performance in modules related to that in which the I grade has been awarded. As part of the grade review process, the academic staff member may require the student to submit additional work.
e) Examination during the relevant repeat assessment period

3.2.4 **M Grades**

3.2.4.1 An M grade shall be awarded only in the case of sequential modules approved for such grading by the Provost & Deputy President prior to the commencement of the sequence and satisfying the following conditions.

a) Normally, there shall be no more than two modules in an M-graded sequence.
b) The Provost & Deputy President will need to be satisfied that there is a sound pedagogic reason for assessing over two modules.
c) The Provost & Deputy President will need to be satisfied that students on whose programmes the module sequence is a requirement do not have an excessive number of M-graded modules in the relevant semesters.
d) Both modules in the sequence shall be offered in consecutive semesters of the same academic year.
e) To provide feedback to students, an interim assessment shall take place by the end of the first semester of the M-graded sequence, which shall be worth at least 20% of the total grade in the module.
f) Normally, both modules shall be taught and coordinated by the same academic staff member(s).
g) Credits shall be awarded only at the end of the sequence.
h) The final grade awarded shall be the same in each semester in which the M-graded sequence occurred. In exceptional circumstances, e.g. the case of the major project module, the award of different grades in each of the semesters may be permitted.

3.2.5 **NG Grades**

3.2.5.1 NG grades should be awarded only in cases where a student has submitted no assessment material for a module and no certification has been received to support the award of an I grade.

3.2.6 **Repeat Grades**

3.2.6.1 Grades awarded at the annual repeats will be capped at C3. In such cases, the higher of the original grade and repeat grade will stand.

3.2.6.2 Grades awarded to students repeating a maximum of two modules per semester on a link-in basis will not be capped. In such cases, the higher of the original grade and the repeat grade will stand. For the avoidance of doubt, where a module that is repeated on a link-in basis is further repeated at the annual repeats, the grade awarded for the latter will be capped at C3, provided that in such circumstances the higher of the original grade and the repeat grade will stand.

3.2.7 **Grading of Modules Taken in Partner Institutions**

3.2.7.1 The University encourages students to participate in placements in other academic institutions, both nationally and internationally. To this end, the University may recognise grades awarded by the partner institution and award credits accordingly.

3.2.7.2 An institutional agreement shall be in place prior to participation by University of Limerick students in placements in other institutions. Such agreements shall be executed only in the case of University of Limerick compatible institutions.

3.2.7.3 A learning agreement and grade translation agreement shall be in place in advance of student exchange/placement. Learning agreements shall be executed only in the case of University of Limerick compatible courses.

3.2.7.4 Up to 50% of part 2 of an academic programme can be taken in partner institutions, i.e. a total of three of the six semesters in part 2, including Cooperative Education placement. This would

be an upper limit. Placement on programmes such as ERASMUS is limited to a total of one academic year.

3.2.7.5 A more restrictive policy may operate at individual programme level.

3.2.7.6 Course directors of academic programmes that require students to undertake a compulsory placement in a partner institution shall ensure that the precise parameters are specified in the programme documentation approved by Academic Council. Course directors of academic programmes that offer students the option of a placement in a partner institution shall, following consultation with the International Office or Exchange Coordinator, as appropriate, seek relevant course board approval of the proposed placement.

3.2.7.7 UL Global shall be consulted in relation to the proposed parameters for studying abroad in new courses or during the revision of existing courses prior to approval being sought in accordance with 3.2.7.6.

3.2.7.8 The exchange coordinator or equivalent shall approve individual student participation in a placement in another institution.

3.2.7.9 In advance of the study abroad placement, the exchange coordinator or equivalent shall advise students registered on University of Limerick academic programmes incorporating modules exempted by professional bodies of any implications for exemptions, postgraduate study, etc.

3.2.7.10 Students are expected to spend their final year at University of Limerick. Exceptions must be approved in advance by the course director and exchange coordinators.

3.2.7.11 Unless otherwise approved by Academic Council, the following arrangements shall apply in relation to the grading of students undertaking placements in partner institutions.

a) Final year modules taken in a partner institution, including any final year modules taken in lieu of Cooperative Education placement or professional placement, should be quality graded.
b) Students undertaking a compulsory placement shall be graded on a pass/fail basis in all years prior to their final year of study.
c) Students doing an elective placement before their final year will be graded pass/fail unless approved by the Provost or their nominee to be graded on a quality-graded basis.
d) With the exception of final year modules (which should be graded in accordance with item a) above), modules taken abroad in lieu of Cooperative Education placement should be graded Pass/Fail.

3.2.7.12 All assessments should be completed before the University of Limerick student leaves the host university. In addition, the onus is on individual students, in consultation with their exchange coordinators, to ensure that arrangements are in place for the transmission of grades from their host university to the appropriate office in University of Limerick.

3.2.7.13 The exchange coordinator shall advise Academic Registry and UL Global of individual student study abroad arrangements.

3.2.8 Changes of Approved Grades

3.2.8.1 In exceptional cases, a grade may be changed after the original grade has been approved by the Academic Council Grading Committee. Such a change may occur when an academic staff member:

a) Discovers an error in the approved grade
b) Reviews an individual grade in response to a request from the Head of Department
c) Reviews overall or individual performance in a module on the advice of the external examiner

d) Reviews an individual grade in response to a grade recheck request in accordance with section 3.2.9
e) Reviews an individual grade in response to a grade appeal request in accordance with section 3.2.10

3.2.8.2 In relation to 3.2.8.1 b) and 3.2.8.1 c), approved grades may be changed only up to and including the point where a progression decision is made in relation to the student.

3.2.8.3 In cases where the grade change places the student in another final award classification category, the course director and/or Head of Department should consult with the external examiner(s) in line with the External Examiner Policy.

3.2.8.4 The Module Leader shall submit the change of the approved grade, with clear reasons for that change, by following the procedure published by Academic Registry. The Head of Department or their nominee will approve the change to the approved grade prior to submission to Academic Registry.

3.2.9 **Recheck of Approved Grade**

3.2.9.1 Should a student consider that they may have been assigned an incorrect grade, they may request a recheck of the approved grade.

3.2.9.2 A request to recheck an approved grade must be made within 10 full working days of the relevant module results becoming available.

3.2.9.3 To request a recheck of an approved grade, the student must complete the appropriate form (available from Academic Registry) and pay a fee, the amount of which shall be decided by the Provost & Deputy President.

3.2.9.4 A recheck of an approved grade cannot be carried out on those parts of an assessment where a sufficient and intact record of the original assessment is not available. This includes assessments where the original submission by the student does not remain under the control of the University or where sufficient records are not available to permit regrading.

3.2.9.5 For the avoidance of doubt, a recheck of an approved grade may result in the approved grade being increased, decreased or confirmed as accurate.

3.2.9.6 The following procedure should be followed by the academic staff member responsible for the relevant module:

a) Where available, review all submissions in relation to the module assessment. Review all submissions to establish whether or not the original mark/grade awarded was correct. Where a sufficient and intact record of the original assessment is not available, the original mark/grade assigned to that element of the assessment remains.
b) Check to ensure that marks given to individual elements of an assessment are included in the total marks.
c) Check that the original total mark, where applicable, is accurate and that the approved grade is correct.

3.2.9.7 Where the recheck of an approved grade results in a grade change, the grade change should be processed in line with 3.2.8.3.

3.2.9.8 Where the recheck of an approved grade results in the original grade being confirmed as accurate, the Module Leader shall submit the outcome, with clear reasons for that outcome, by following the procedure published by Academic Registry.

3.2.9.9 The outcome for a recheck of an approved grade must be submitted to Academic Registry within 10 working days of the grade recheck submission deadline with the exception of the summer/repeat exam period, where all grade recheck outcomes must be submitted within five working days.

3.2.9.10 Where a recheck of an approved grade results in a change of approved grade, any recheck fee paid by the student for this module will be refunded by Academic Registry.

3.2.10 **Appeal of Approved Grade**

3.2.10.1 Following the outcome of a recheck of an approved grade, the student may appeal an approved grade to the Head of Department responsible for the module.

3.2.10.2 An appeal of an approved grade must be on specific and stated grounds, and the submission must include a full and complete statement on why the student believes the approved grade is incorrect.

3.2.10.3 A request to appeal an approved grade must be made within five full working days of the publication of the recheck of an approved grade outcome.

3.2.10.4 To appeal an approved grade, the student must complete the appropriate form (available from Academic Registry) and pay a fee, the amount of which shall be decided by the Provost & Deputy President.

3.2.10.5 An appeal of an approved grade cannot be carried out on those parts of an assessment where a satisfactory record of the original assessment is not available. This includes assessments where the original submission by the student does not remain under the control of the University or where sufficient records are not available to permit regrading.

3.2.10.6 For the avoidance of doubt, an appeal of an approved grade may result in the approved grade being increased, decreased or confirmed as accurate.

3.2.10.7 The following procedure should be followed by the Head of Department or their nominee(s) when dealing with an appeal of an approved grade:

a) Review the stated grounds on the appeal of an approved grade request.
b) Reassess all submissions in relation to the module assessment with reference to the stated grounds of appeal. In line with 3.2.9.6 where a sufficient record of the original assessment is not available, the original mark/grade assigned to that element of the assessment remains.
c) Check to ensure that marks given to individual elements of all submissions to the module assessment are included in the total marks.
d) Check that the original total mark is accurate and that the grade awarded is correct.

3.2.10.8 Where the appeal of an approved grade results in a grade change, the grade change should be processed in line with 3.2.8.3.

3.2.10.9 Where the appeal of an approved grade results in the original grade being confirmed as accurate, the Head of Department or their nominee shall submit the outcome, with clear reasons for that outcome, by following the procedure published by Academic Registry.

3.2.10.10 The outcome for an appeal of an approved grade must be submitted to Academic Registry by the Head of Department or their nominee within 10 working days of receipt of the appeal of an approved grade submission. In exceptional circumstances, the University may increase this period by a further five working days.

3.2.10.11 Where an appeal of an approved grade results in a change of approved grade, any fee paid by the student to recheck the approved grade and/or appeal an approved grade for this module will be refunded by Academic Registry.

3.3 Student Progression

3.3.1 Quality Credit Average (QCA)

3.3.1.1 The semester quality credit average (QCA) represents the average quality of a student's performance in all modules taken in one semester. The cumulative QCA represents the average quality of a student's performance in all modules taken to date in a particular programme of study.

3.3.1.2 Semester QCA is calculated using the following formula (where QCS = quality credit score, Att Hrs = attempted hours and Non-Q hours = non-quality hours).

$$\frac{\text{Sum of QCS}}{\text{(Sum of Att Hrs)} - \text{(Sum of Non-Q hours)}}$$

Note 1: The QCS score for a particular module is the quality point value (QPV) score for that module multiplied by the module credit value (e.g. 3). The QPV score is a numerical value assigned to grades A1 to NG on a scale from 4 to 0.

Note 2: Each year of study of a programme is given a factor weighting. For programmes that include a three-year part 2, Year 2 carries a factor weighting of 1 while years 3 and 4 each carry a factor of 2.

Refer to the Calculating QCA section of the Student Handbook (accessible on the Academic Registry website) for a detailed explanation of how cumulative and semester QCA are calculated.

3.3.2 Faculty Examination Boards

3.3.2.1 Each Faculty Board shall appoint a Faculty Examination Board/Boards to review, each semester, the module grades awarded to each student in the programme(s) assigned to that board for consideration.

3.3.2.2 Where a programme is managed by a sole department, the relevant Faculty Examination Board shall be convened and chaired by the Head of that department or their nominee. Where a programme is managed by more than one department within a faculty, the Dean or their nominee shall convene and chair the relevant Faculty Examination Board.

3.3.2.3 Where a programme is managed by more than one department across more than one faculty, the relevant Deans' nominee shall convene and chair the relevant Faculty Examination Board.

3.3.2.4 In all cases, the Faculty Examination Board shall comprise the relevant heads of department, course directors, specialist academic staff and appropriate academic staff responsible for teaching the modules graded in the semester under consideration.

3.3.2.5 Faculty Examination Boards shall decide on the progress of students within the marginal performance limits specified in SP 3.3.5, 3.3.6 and 3.3.7.

3.3.2.6 Faculty Examination Boards shall make recommendations to the Academic Council Grading Committee as to the progress of students whose academic performance falls below the marginal performances specified in s SP 3.3.5, 3.3.6 and 3.3.7.

3.3.2.7 Faculty Examination Boards shall convene each semester in advance of the meeting of the Academic Council Grading Committee. (AR 1.5.2)

3.3.3 Minimum Performance Standards

3.3.3.1 Minimum performance standards are specified in AR 1.5.3. The Academic Council Grading Committee normally allows a student to complete one full academic year of a programme before formally reviewing the student's progress with a view to determining whether or not

the student should proceed. The Academic Council Grading Committee formally reviews the progress of students at the end of each academic year of a programme, at the end of the final academic semester of a part of a programme, prior to placement on Cooperative Education or other professional placement (for example, school placement and clinical placement) and following the annual repeats. These students' progress is reviewed initially by the relevant Faculty Examination Board.

3.3.3.2 Students whose academic performance conforms to the minimum standards are required to proceed.

3.3.3.3 Academic Registry produces reports at the end of each semester that summarise the performance of each student. Items 3.3.5.1, 4.3.6.1 and 3.3.7.1 below state the critical categories of students about whose progression Examination Boards are required to make recommendations.

3.3.4 **Progression**

3.3.4.1 Progression decisions are conveyed online to Academic Registry by 11:00 on the morning of the Academic Council Grading Committee meeting. The outcomes of the Academic Council Grading Committee's decisions on progression are conveyed to the students by Academic Registry.

3.3.4.2 No additional provisions will be made for visiting students.

3.3.5 **Progression Following Autumn Semester**

3.3.5.1 Only students due to start Cooperative Education placement or other professional placement in the Spring semester are subject to critical review. Once a student has progressed into the year in which the Cooperative Education or other professional placement takes place, progression to such placement is automatic except in those cases where students who are required to repeat the year or part thereof would be prevented from doing so by the timing of the placement.

3.3.5.2 Students who have not met the minimum standards will, on the recommendation of the relevant Examination Board, be required to do one of the following:

a) Take annual repeats for a maximum of two modules (excluding I grades) from the Autumn semester
b) Repeat a full semester
c) Repeat the full year
d) Have their enrolment terminated

3.3.5.3 Faculty Examination Boards may specify modules to be repeated by non-progressing students.

3.3.5.4 Eligibility for access to the annual repeats is based on a residual QCA of at least 2.00.

3.3.6 **Progression Following Spring Semester**

3.3.6.1 All students are subject to critical review in the Spring semester. Progression to Cooperative Education placement is automatic except in those cases where students who are required to repeat the year or part thereof would be prevented from doing so by the timing of the placement. However, prospective graduates are dealt with via the Academic Council Examination Board process.

3.3.6.2 Students who do not achieve the minimum standard outlined in AR 1.5.3 shall, at the discretion of the relevant Faculty Examination Board, be permitted to do one of the following:

a) Take annual repeats for a maximum of four modules in any two-semester academic year.
b) Repeat a full semester
c) Repeat the full year

d) Have their enrolment terminated

3.3.6.3 Faculty Examination Boards may specify modules to be repeated by non-progressing students.

3.3.6.4 Eligibility for access to the annual repeats is based on a residual QCA of at least 2.00.

3.3.7 **Progression Following Annual Repeats**

3.3.7.1 All students availing of annual repeats are subject to critical review following the annual repeats. With the exception of students on Cooperative Education placement who are not required to repeat any Autumn semester modules under 4.3.7.2 below and provided the Examination Board has not required their enrolment to be terminated, students who have not achieved the minimum standard cannot proceed to the next year of study.

3.3.7.2 Students who do not achieve the minimum standard outlined in AR 1.5.3 shall, at the discretion of the relevant Faculty Examination Board, be permitted to do one of the following:

a) Repeat a maximum of two modules with deficient or compensating fail grades in any one semester on a link-in basis
b) Repeat a full semester
c) Repeat the full year
d) Have their enrolment terminated

3.4 Student Status Committees

3.4.1 **Composition**

3.4.1.1 In the case of departments who run programmes fully, each department head shall appoint at least three members of academic staff to the Student Status Committee of the department to review applications from students on that programme(s) (one of whom shall be appointed as chairperson).

3.4.1.2 In the case of programmes run jointly by more than one department within a faculty, the Dean of Faculty shall appoint an appropriate Student Status Committee.

3.4.1.3 In the case of programmes run jointly by more than one faculty, the relevant Deans shall appoint an appropriate Student Status Committee.

3.4.1.4 In the case of a faculty whose Dean appoints course boards on the recommendation of the Faculty Board, the relevant course board shall appoint sub-committees of their members as Student Status Committees.

3.4.2 **Functions**

3.4.2.1 The Student Status Committees must operate within the parameters laid down in the Academic Regulations and Marks and Standards chapters of this handbook.

3.4.2.2 The Student Status Committees deal with the following applications (AR 1.2.10):

a) Application for readmission
b) Application for leave of absence
c) Application for internal transfer (programme)
d) Application for exemptions
e) Application for alternative to external academic placement
f) Application to appeal academic status

3.4.2.3 Students who are dissatisfied with the decision of the Student Status Committees may appeal the decision at the time and in the manner specified from time to time by the University.

3.4.2.4 The Student Status Committees will operate as a de-facto Examination Board when considering such appeals of academic status.

3.4.3 **Schedule**

3.4.3.1 The committees shall convene not later than:

a) Autumn semester business: Wednesday Week 2, Spring semester
b) Spring semester business: Wednesday, six weeks after module grade submission deadline
c) Annual repeats business: Wednesday of Week 2, Autumn semester

and at other times as deemed necessary following discussion between the Provost & Deputy President (or nominee) and committee chairs(s).

3.4.3.2 The chairs of all Student Status Committees shall meet together within two working days following each scheduled meeting of the committees. The Provost & Deputy President (or nominee) shall convene and chair this meeting. The meeting is designed to (i) ensure that decisions of the Student Status Committees are in compliance with the academic regulations and associated procedures, (ii) facilitate the exchange of information, (iii) provide an opportunity for a review of the norms being applied by the Student Status Committees and (iv) elicit, for the information of the Academic Status Appeals Committee, the views of the chairs on any individual case being referred to it.

3.4.4 **Procedures**

3.4.4.1 Applications should be submitted at the times and in the manner specified to the student from time to time by the University. Application forms and advice on eligibility for consideration of all student requests for a review of their status are available from Academic Registry. Details can be found on the Student Hub Online, which is accessible from the Academic Registry website.

3.4.4.2 All applications shall be considered at the next available sitting of the relevant Student Status Committee.

3.4.4.3 In exceptional circumstances, as approved by the Provost & Deputy President (or nominee), it may be necessary to obtain a decision on an application before the next available sitting of the relevant Student Status Committee. Where this occurs, the chairperson of the relevant Student Status Committee shall be responsible for determining an outcome. The chairperson may decide to seek the views of other members of their committee before making a decision.

3.4.4.4 The student under consideration may be required to attend the relevant Student Status Committee meeting. Where a student has been required to attend, they may be accompanied by a person of their choosing.

3.4.4.5 The Student Status Committee shall have due regard to the following factors in deciding on applications that request a transfer or readmission:

a) Points requirement in the year of entry/re-entry for the programme of study sought
b) Quotas applying in the year of entry/re-entry to that programme
c) The Central Applications Office (CAO) policy and Academic Registry procedures for the filling of vacant places in Year 1
d) The timing of the request for transfer and its implications for the student's ability to complete the programme in the normal way
e) The views of the Student Status Committee in the department from which the student is requesting a transfer

3.4.4.6 In granting a transfer or readmission, the Student Status Committee may attach special conditions and/or require satisfactory completion of additional prescribed work.

3.4.5 Decisions of the Student Status Committees will be notified to students by Academic Registry in line with published timelines.

Application for Readmission

3.4.5.1 Students seeking readmission to the University are required to make their application to the Student Status Committee.

3.4.6 **Application for Leave of Absence**

3.4.6.1 Normally, the student will be expected to fulfil the following conditions before being granted leave of absence:

a) Completion of one semester (or the year for year-based programmes) at the University on the programme for which the student is currently enrolled
b) Be in good academic standing
c) Where the chairs' meeting is satisfied that the student's academic standing was directly affected by the factors cited in support of the student's application for leave, the 'good standing' condition may be waived.

3.4.6.2 The following circumstances, confirmed by a brief letter without the need to share confidential details, shall be considered to be acceptable reasons for granting leave of absence:

a) Certified illness
b) Financial hardship
c) Family bereavement
d) Psychological, emotional or social problems supported confidentially by one or more of the following people:
    - Medical officer
    - Family doctor
    - Counsellor
    - Chaplain
e) Vocational uncertainty: The student will be expected to submit evidence of a plan to deal constructively with the vocational uncertainty during the leave of absence.

3.4.6.3 Students wishing to recommence their studies immediately after an approved leave of absence may do so at the time and in the manner specified from time to time by the University.

3.4.7 **Application for Internal Transfer**

3.4.7.1 Students seeking an internal transfer after Year 1, Semester 1 from one programme of study to another within the University are required to make their application to the Student Status Committee.

3.4.8 **Application for Exemption**

3.4.8.1 The question of exemption from a full semester or year(s) of a programme of study is handled as part of the student's admission. Application for exemption from an individual module not covered in the admission process shall be made to the Student Status Committee before the commencement of the semester in which the module is due to be taken. To be eligible for exemption, students are expected to have achieved a minimum pass standard in any equivalent module.

3.4.8.2 Upon consultation with the relevant course directors, the Student Status Committee may decide to award an exemption or carry forward the previous module grade, as appropriate.

3.4.8.3 Students required to repeat a year or a full semester under the progression policy are not eligible for exemption in individual modules in that year or semester.

3.4.9 **Application for Alternative to External Academic Placement**

3.4.9.1 In exceptional circumstances, students on programmes where an external academic placement is a core element may apply to achieve by alternative means the relevant number of credits applicable to the external academic placement.

3.4.10 **Application to Appeal Academic Status**

3.4.10.1 Students wishing to appeal against a decision on their academic status must apply to the Student Status Committee.

3.4.10.2 An appeal against the decision of an Academic Council Grading Committee/University Examination Board shall be considered on the following grounds only:

a) On grounds of severity (in academic terms only) of the method of repeat specified by the Faculty Examination Board. The Student Status Committee shall be entitled to modify the decision on the method of repeat.

b) If there is evidence of substantial irregularity in the conduct of the examination or its assessment.

3.4.11 **Academic Status Appeals Committee**

3.4.11.1 In the case of an appeal under the ground listed in 3.4.10.2 b),the chair of the relevant Student Status Committee shall refer such cases to the Academic Status Appeals Committee following consideration of the case by the chairs committee. The chair of the relevant Student Status Committee shall present the case to the Academic Status Appeals Committee.

3.4.11.2 The Academic Status Appeals Committee will consider cases brought on grounds of substantial irregularity in the conduct of examination or assessment.

3.4.11.3 The Academic Status Appeals Committee shall be chaired and convened by the Provost & Deputy President in the case of students in taught programmes or by the Vice President Research & Innovation in the case of postgraduate research students. The committee shall comprise the Deans of Faculty and a person external to University of Limerick appointed by the chairperson in consultation with the relevant Associate Vice President.

3.4.11.4 The Associate Vice President Academic Affairs, Associate Vice President Doctoral College and Assistant Deans Academic Affairs shall be alternate members and shall deputise in the event of unavoidable absence of one or more members. Where the appeal relates to a postgraduate research candidate, the Assistant Deans Research shall deputise.

3.4.11.5 The Dean (or alternate) of the faculty affected by the appeal shall withdraw from the Academic Status Appeals Committee while such an appeal is being considered.

3.4.11.6 The Academic Status Appeals Committee will, in accordance with the principles of natural justice, consider an appeal on the grounds on which it is based and consult with all appropriate stakeholders, including internal examiner(s) and, where it considers it necessary, external examiner(s).

3.4.11.7 The Academic Status Appeals Committee will make such recommendations as it deems necessary but on a basis that will not undermine the University's regulations. The committee shall present to the Academic Council a report summarising the case and incorporating recommendations for consideration by the Academic Council

3.4.11.8 The decision of the Academic Council shall be final.

3.5 General Examination Regulations

3.5.1 Attendance at Examination Venues

3.5.1.1 Students shall not be permitted to enter the examination venue after the first 20 minutes of the scheduled examination time has elapsed.

3.5.1.2 Students may not leave the examination venue before the first 30 minutes of the examination time has elapsed.

3.5.1.3 Students may not leave the examination venue during the last 10 minutes of the examination. Students present during the last 10 minutes of the examination must remain in their seats until all examination materials have been collected.

3.5.2 Authorised and Unauthorised Material

3.5.2.1 Students may only have authorised material in their possession in an examination venue:

a) Authorised material that students may bring into the examination venue includes writing instruments, drawing instruments, University of Limerick student ID card or other valid photo identification and additional authorised material approved as per 3.5.2.2.

b) Authorised material includes students' mobile phones, which they may bring into the examination venue. These must be switched off at all times, not simply set to silent mode. Mobile phones must be placed face down on the floor beneath the student's examination desk for the duration of the examination.

c) Authorised material, such as paper, examination booklets, rough work sheets, graph paper, etc., will be provided by the Exam Venue Coordinators.

3.5.2.2 Additional materials may be classified as authorised material by the relevant staff member where prior consultation has taken place with Academic Registry. Such material includes:

a) Dictionaries, textbooks, mathematical tables, handouts, lecture notes
b) Electronic devices necessary for completion of the examination.

3.5.2.3 Unauthorised material includes calculator covers, pencil cases, outdoor clothing, bags, and smart devices (other than mobile phones).

a) Students may not have in their possession authorised material that includes or has attached to it unauthorised material, such as written notes or inserts.
b) Writing of any kind on clothing or any part of the body may be considered to be unauthorised material.

3.5.2.4 In the examination venue, students may write only on authorised paper and/or create and store data using only authorised electronic devices, and only such authorised material will be submitted to the examiner(s) for correction. Students shall not remove any of these items from the examination venue.

3.5.2.5 If a student is in doubt as to whether material is authorised or unauthorised, they should ask an Exam Venue Coordinator before the examination begins.

3.5.3 During the Examination

3.5.3.1 Students shall comply with all directions from the Exam Venue Coordinators.

3.5.3.2 Students are required to present on entrance to an examination venue a valid UL student card. In exceptional circumstances, other valid photo identification or documentation as prescribed by the University will be acceptable. Entry will not be permitted without such identification or documentation.

3.5.3.3 Students shall display valid identification on their desk or assigned work areas.

3.5.3.4 A clean desk policy is in operation for all examinations: only authorised stationery and material and the valid identification will be allowed on the desk.

3.5.3.5 Students shall not engage in unauthorised collaboration or attempted collaboration, copying or attempted copying.

3.5.3.6 Each student is responsible for ensuring that their examination materials are in the possession of an Exam Venue Coordinator before leaving the examination venue. Students shall write their ID number clearly on all materials submitted to the Exam Venue Coordinator.

3.5.3.7 A student who is considered to have breached or attempted to breach the general examination regulations shall be informed at the earliest opportunity by an Exam Venue Coordinator, in the presence of a witness (viz., another Exam Venue Coordinator, an academic staff member or a student). Where a breach of the general examination regulations relates to possession of unauthorised material, such material may be retained by the Exam Venue Coordinator and forwarded to the Office of the Provost & Deputy President along with the completed Breach of General Examination Regulations paperwork. The student is then allowed to finish the examination. Subsequent procedures are outlined in the Student Code of Conduct and Procedures for Managing Allegations of Academic Misconduct.